Do You Cry My Name in the Dark (Like I Do Yours)

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/44701960.

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Mature

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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by Poputchik

Summary

The morning after .

Notes

I wrote this because I do what I want.

If you would rather leave BYMNM as a standalone in your mind, that's okay with me, but I felt like writing this, and so I did.

One eye opens, and she hesitates.

The second eye opens, and she hesitates.

A swirl of sensations fades into her, and she focuses.

Toes wiggle.

Hair tickles her forehead, buoyed by the rhythm of a soft, warm breeze.

Lungs expand, and she feels the air enter and exit.

Feels it in her mouth, in her nose.

All of these sensations are a message.

She is *here*.

But still, she hesitates.

The breeze pushes loose hair across her forehead, again, and she knows.

I'm here.

Because the breeze isn't a breeze.

It's breath.

And she feels the source of it - the gentle, comforting presence of warm limbs that drape themselves across her body;the slight, rumbling purr that vibrates through her.

She chances a look down, and finds herself staring, transfixed.

An almost chaotic mess of dark brown hair falls to frame a familiar face - a face that rests peacefully, unaware of how the morning light

illuminates a dusting of freckles, how the sun kisses thin lips and warm cheeks, and-

And her heart *aches*.

The hair itself is longer now - untold months of unchecked growth leading to the slight ponytail she'd undone as they'd fallen into bed, pressing themselves into each other like the air in between was nothing more than the magnetic charge pulling their bodies together.

The bed itself is in a cottage she' s never seen, in a part of the Woods that she doesn't know , but it feels *lived* in. Like whomever built it, built themself a life here - alone, away from the rest of the world.

"I can feel those gears turning, dummy ," a raspy voice says, thick with sleep and affection.

She pulls her wandering eyes back to the face at her chest, and finds brilliant, loving pools of blue and gold as they stare lazily up at her.

"What' s going on up there?" is the next question, and a clawed index finger lightly taps her forehead.

And she turns the answering words around in her head, inspecting, placing them in an order that she thinks makes sense.

"I just- I guess I just realized that I missed *so much*," she breathes, and finds her voice cracking on the last. She hasn't given voice to the question that' s set itself in her mind, but she forces what strength she has to push it up and out, so maybe she'll *know*.

"How long?" is all that escapes before she realizes she can't breathe anymore.

The body that' s wrapped around her tenses, and the face ducks away, and for a moment, she feels like falling - like she's coming

apart at the seams, being undone again-

And somehow, unexpectedly , an old familiar feeling pulls her back as it wraps itself gently around her leg.

The answer comes a second later , and though she feels her breathing hitch, it doesn't pull her back under .

"A year ."

A hand starts making small circles on her stomach, and she focuses on the feeling.

It' s not as long as she thought - or, well, she didn't really know *what* she thought, but given the evidence in front of her, she had assumed worse.

A year.

And she's missed it. A thought strikes her then, hard, and dark, and true. They must have-

"We had a ceremony," she hears, the slightly melancholy realization that they're still so in sync after all this time brushing against her before vanishing into the early morning rays. "Well, two, actually. They made a statue for the big one."

She doesn't know how she' s going to reckon with that, so she pushes the thought away, as she waits for the words to continue.

"We did another one - a smaller one, just for us." There' s a shake, a slight ruffling of hair - as if forcing away a painful thought. "It' s weird. It didn't really feel like saying 'goodbye'. Even though I knew you were gone-"

The hand that' s been making lazy circles on her stomach grips the hem of her shirt and squeezes, clenched while a feeling passes.

“I don’t think I really said ‘goodbye’ until yesterday - when I left that letter.”

She feels her eyebrows scrunch in confusion, “What letter?”

Those eyes turn up at her again, painted in their own bewilderment, “The letter I wrote you. In the book?”

Book? What book-

The color drains from her face as she realizes exactly which book - one that she’d never intended for *anyone* to read. She’d said so many things, so many *stupid, stupid* things.

A hand rubs the side of her jaw and her brain freezes.

“Hey . It’s okay. It was like getting to know you - the parts of you I’d missed because I was too stubborn and hurt to give you a chance.”

And again, she’s floating back down, paralysis dissolving from her muscles, the feeling of understanding, and of being understood, keeping her almost featherlight.

And then she hears a question she doesn’t expect.

“So, what was it like? Wherever you were.”

At first, she doesn’t know how to answer . The feeling is ephemeral, like she had existed in a fog of unbeing, and the memory of it is a ghost that she can reach for, but it evaporates in the curl of her fingers. So she latches on to the emotions, instead.

“I don’t know , really. It was like... I didn’t really have a sense of myself. All I had was a vague sense of... love, and warmth. That was pretty much it, except-,” and she realizes she’s been waving her free hand as if it could give imagery or emphasis to what’s essentially nonsense. She realizes this, because the words she’s about to speak stop her in her tracks, and her mind reaches out for anything *else* to focus on. But she has to say it, because it’s *important*.

"except for *you*. I could feel you. I could feel how you hurt. And I think I could feel all of the magic throughout the planet, and it was... sad. Like hurting you, was hurting me, was hurting it. Like it never intended to take me away, and it just needed time. To bring me back. I think, anyway . I'm not really sure."

The silence after her answer stretches, uncertain - unwinding the strength of her conviction that this, that *she*, is real.

Finally, a gentle, "*Hmm*."

The movement is swift, but careful, as legs swing over her , and hands grip her shirt to pull her up, her face inches from - from *everything*.

"Well it can't have you back, ever again, okay?" The words are sharp, and desperate, and all she can do is wrap an arm around a waist, pulling herself closer, forehead pressed to forehead, and answer.

"I'm *never* leaving again. No matter *what* happens. I'm not going *anywhere*," she whispers, and it' s with a passion, a determination she feels radiating out from her very bones.

And somehow, she knows it's true.

"Promise?"

t' s hopeful, but frantic.

But *she*, she is *fearless*.

"I promise."

Hands grip the sides of her face and lips press into hers, and they are hot, and hungry and she presses back with everything she has because she *never* wants to forget what it - what *this* feels like.

Their first was sweet, and warm, and a perfect moment of euphoric elation that had been a lifetime in the making, but this - this is long, and heavy, and every bit the desperate grasp it should be, a kiss between two people separated by the end of the world.

Two people who were ripped apart by life and death, and somehow *still* came out the other side.

When they finally let go, they're still pressed together - forehead to forehead, eye to eye.

Flickering, vivid blue to fiery gold and cerulean.

They smile, together , their faces flushed, and for the first time - something like content.

And she *feels* the words, as the heat of breath breaks on her lips.

"Hey , Adora."

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!